



Professional Communication

- The Discussion forums on CloudDeakin unit sites are the primary location where students should ask questions about a unit of study.
- Personal and private queries should be sent to the unit Chair or relevant Campus Coordinator via email.

Please observe the following guidelines in all your online communications. These guidelines will ensure polite, effective, efficient and professional communication with University staff and fellow students, and is “good practice”, which is expected in the world of work. If these guidelines are not followed, there may be a delay in receiving a reply.

- Before posting questions on CloudDeakin, or sending email queries to staff, check that the answer does not already exist online, for example in the Unit guide, Class notes, Assignment Guides, News items or in earlier posts to the ‘Questions for Unit Chair’ Discussion Forum.
- All online communication with university staff should:
 - Include a polite greeting (e.g. *Hi Albert, Dear Albert or Dear Dr Einstein*),
 - and a polite farewell (e.g. *Regards Niels*),
 - include your campus of study
 - be written in plain English
- When sending an email to university staff your email must:
 - come from a deakin.edu.au account¹,
 - be directed, in the first instance, to the relevant campus co-ordinator/lecturer/tutor,
 - include the unit of study and enquiry, in the Subject line,
 - include your name, student number and campus of study in your signature.²

1. Deakin emails can be linked to a private email address (e.g., gmail).

2. A ‘signature’ can be set up in Outlook, which will add this information to every email sent.

Further information on managing email can be found at

www.deakin.edu.au/about-deakin/administrative-divisions/esolutions/it-help/email-and-calendars